DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION • BUREAU OF LEARNING DELIVERY

DepEd Reading Treasury

Anthology of Classic Philippine Literature & Reflective Selections

National Reading Program (NRP) Student Companion

A Message to the Filipino Learner:

Reading is the bedrock of lifelong learning, critical thought, and empathy. The Department of Education's National Reading Program invites every student to discover the wonders of our literary heritage. Within these pages, you will encounter the legends that formed our ancestral lore, the virtues of perseverance rooted in our natural landscapes, and the profound stories of human purpose. Read with an inquisitive heart, ponder each lesson, and let every word strengthen your voice as an enlightened citizen.

Anthology Contents

Selection I: The Legend of Mount Mayon (Daragang Magayon)	Folklore / Bicol
Selection II: The Wisdom and Resilience of the Bamboo	Reflective Essay
Selection III: The Hawk and the Hen	Traditional Fable
Epilogue: Vocabulary Enhancement & Reflection Prompts	Guided Inquiry

Selection I: The Legend of Mount Mayon

Retold from the Traditional Bicolano Oral Epic

Long before the volcano cast its graceful conical shadow across the fertile plains of Albay, there lived in the kingdom of Ibalon a chieftain named Makusog. His only daughter was Daragang Magayon, renowned across the islands for both her peerless beauty and the gentle compassion she extended to all living creatures. Suitors from distant provinces traveled across treacherous seas to seek her favor, including the haughty and aggressive warrior Pagtuga, who amassed gold and hunting trophies to purchase her affection.

One morning while bathing in the rushing Yawa River, Magayon slipped on a moss-covered boulder and fell into the swirling rapids. Hearing her cries, an honorable young warrior named Ulap—son of a respected leader from Laguna—plunged into the torrent and carried her safely ashore. Their chance encounter ignited a deep and enduring devotion built upon mutual admiration and dignity. Makusog blessed their intended union, bringing joy across the realm.

Bitter with jealousy, Pagtuga abducted Chief Makusog and threatened his life unless Magayon agreed to marry him. To save her father, Magayon reluctantly agreed. However, on the wedding day, Ulap led a brave band of warriors to rescue them. A fierce battle ensued. Though Pagtuga was defeated, a stray arrow struck Magayon, and Ulap was felled as he rushed to embrace her. Overcome with grief, Chief Makusog buried the young lovers side by side. In the moons that followed, the earth above their mound rose gracefully toward the heavens, forming the majestic, perfectly proportioned Mount Mayon. When the mountain rumbles softly, elders say Ulap and Magayon are speaking; when clouds wreath the peak, they are embracing once more.

Selection II: The Wisdom and Resilience of the Bamboo

Reflective Essay on Filipino Character (Katatagan)

Across the archipelago, violent typhoons sweep over the islands with howling winds that snap ancient oaks and uproot massive mahogany trees. Yet when the tempest subsides and the morning sun illuminates the drenched countryside, one plant stands unbroken: the slender, humble bamboo. While mighty trees stubbornly oppose the gale with brittle rigidity, the bamboo bends gracefully to the very earth, offering no futile defiance. It yields to the tempest, waiting patiently until the storm has spent its fury, then springs back erect and triumphant toward the sky.

Filipino cultural philosophers see in the bamboo the defining attribute of our national soul: *katatagan*—resilience. Throughout centuries marked by natural calamities, economic hardships, and historic struggles, the Filipino spirit has never broken. Instead of succumbing to despair, our people adapt with optimism, warmth, and faith. True strength is not measured by rigid pride, but by the humble flexibility that allows one to endure adversity without surrendering dignity.

Selection III: The Hawk and the Hen

Classic Philippine Folklore Fable

In ancient times, the hawk and the hen were steadfast companions living peacefully in the forest. One day, the hen wished to attend an aerial celebration across the valley, but she lacked the ability to soar above the tree canopy. The generous hawk lent her his cherished copper wing-ring, cautioning her: 'Guard this talisman with your life; it was bestowed upon my lineage by our ancestors.'

While dancing joyfully, the careless hen loosened the ring, and it vanished into the tall grass. Ashamed and anxious, she searched day and night but could not recover it. When the hawk returned and discovered her negligence, he declared: 'Until you restore my ancestral ring, you and all your descendants shall scratch the earth in eternal search, and I shall claim your chicks as payment for your broken trust.' To this very day, hens unceasingly scratch the soil looking for the lost talisman, while hawks circle vigilantly from the clouds above.

Reflective Inquiry & Vocabulary Practice

1. Vocabulary in Action:
Identify the contextual meaning of: *peerless* (unmatched), *tempest* (violent storm), *katatagan* (fortitude/resilience), and *talisman* (protective charm). Write original sentences incorporating each term.

2. Critical Deduction:
In *The Wisdom of the Bamboo*, how does the author distinguish between rigid defiance and genuine strength? How can students apply this lesson when facing academic or personal challenges?

3. Ethical Judgment:
Examine the conflict in *The Hawk and the Hen*. Was the hawk's retribution fair, or did both parties bear responsibility? What does this fable teach us about mutual promises and stewardship?